

Workplace intelligence

Change & AI transformation

B2B SaaS

The number no one measures: are people actually heard?

SugApp turns everyday work conversations into a **Respect Index** — and gives each person private coaching — without surveillance. When everything else is changing, it's the signal that tells you whether your teams are holding together.

● Working prototype built

SugApp · working name

Prepared by Suguna Mannepalli



A single, trending, team-level score — the highest-*respect* number, not the highest-*sentiment* one.

01 THE PROBLEM

Every company measures sentiment. None measure respect.

Engagement surveys ask how people *feel*. They miss the thing that actually drives attrition, silence, and burnout: whether people are **listened to and treated with dignity** in the room. “Toxic but polite” sails straight through a sentiment score.

What sentiment sees

| “Thanks for the input! We’ll take it from here.”
Reads as **positive**. Cheerful words, high score.

vs.

What actually happened

| A person was dismissed and stopped contributing.
A **respect** problem — invisible to the tools companies buy today.

Companies spend a fortune on surveys no one answers honestly.

Engagement surveys are expensive, run once or twice a year, and — worst of all — **people don't tell the truth on them.** The fear of being identified and facing retaliation means candor never makes it to the form. Leadership pays a lot to learn very little.

The survey trap

- Costly and annual — stale by the time results land.
- Fear of retaliation kills candor; answers are cover-your-back, not truth.
- Self-reported and gameable — a mirror that shows leaders nothing real.

What SugApp gives leadership

- Continuous — from real behavior, not a once-a-year form.
- Aggregated and k-anonymized — no one is ever exposed, so nothing is hidden out of fear.
- A clear org-wide and team-wide picture of how each team is **growing through self-reflection** — the honest signal surveys were supposed to provide.

Built for the most uncertain workplace in a generation.

AI transformation is reorganizing every team at once — new tools, redefined roles, restructures, and real anxiety about who's still needed. In that turbulence, **how people treat each other is what decides whether change lands or your best people quietly leave.** That's exactly when leaders are flying blind.

Change breaks trust first

Reorgs and AI rollouts erode psychological safety long before they show up in output or in a quarterly survey.

Sentiment is noise now

In upheaval, mood swings with the daily news. Respect & listening is the *durable* signal of whether a team is intact.

The cost is silent

Disengagement and regretted attrition surface months late. Respect is the early-warning light that comes on first.

The signal was always there. The reader just arrived.

Work is text now

Slack, Teams, and chat hold the real record of how colleagues treat each other — dense, continuous, and unmined.

LLMs can finally read nuance

Judging acknowledgement, dismissal, or credit-sharing needs context, not keywords. That capability is new.

Trust is the gating factor

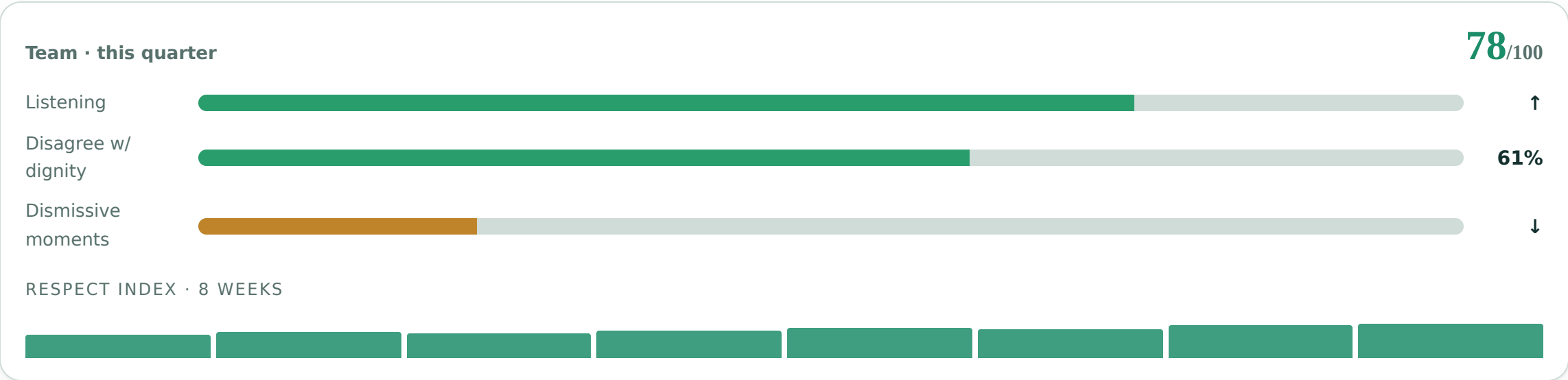
Post-privacy-backlash, the winner isn't whoever reads the most — it's whoever people *trust* to. That's a design choice we make on line one.

A respect & listening layer for the modern workplace.

Connect a channel. SugApp reads the conversation with consent, and produces two things:

- **A private mirror for each person** — their own words, what’s landing well, and one concrete thing to try next.
- **An anonymized Respect Index for the org** — trends over time, never a name, never a quote.

The scoring engine is powered by a **proprietary, validated behavioral taxonomy** — our core IP, held as a trade secret and not shown here.



Culture changes when people see themselves — not when they're told.

Culture doesn't shift with yearly surveys, performance reviews, or 1:1s — those are watched, rated, and remembered. It shifts with **self-reflection**, the part every program skips. The private mirror creates a quiet feedback loop no policy can: each person sees, in their own words, how they're landing — and adjusts one small thing.

1 See yourself — your own words



2 Reflect, privately



3 Adjust one behavior



4 The room shifts

Because **no one is watching but you**, people actually use it — no fear, no scoring, no manager in the middle. One person changing one behavior, repeated across a team, is what slowly moves the needle — and the Respect Index turns that invisible shift into a trend leaders can finally **see**.

Teams that steady themselves through change — no surveillance required.

In uncertain times, teams need to self-correct *fast*. SugApp gives a team a shared, private signal of its own respect & listening health — a mirror for the **group**, not a report up the chain. Strain surfaces to the team itself, in time to do something about it.

A team mirror, not a manager's dashboard

The team sees its own health first and owns the response — support, not scrutiny.

Early warning during change

Rising dismissiveness and falling acknowledgement show up weeks before they show up in resignations.

Self-correction

Shared awareness lets a team reset its own norms mid-reorg — the fastest, cheapest intervention there is.

Leaders get aggregate team health and trend — never individuals — so the whole org can navigate turbulence on the same instrument.

Trust is the product, not the disclaimer.

Anyone can score text. The hard part — and the moat — is being the tool a workforce will actually allow in, *especially* when they're already anxious about AI watching them. We engineered that in from the first commit:

Opt-in, with a real opt-out

No one is scored without consent. Withdrawing deletes what was collected. Enforced in code, not policy.

You see yourself first

The person always sees their own feedback before anyone else — it's a mirror, not a report to your manager.

The org sees aggregates only

Team-level trends, k-anonymized; small teams are suppressed. Never a name, never a quote, up the chain.

Authenticated identity (SSO)

Sign-in-with-Slack ties consent to a verified identity — no impersonation, reliable opt-out.

Sold to the people who now own “managing through change.”

The buyer is **People / HR, People Analytics, and Transformation leaders** — already spending on engagement, DEI, and change-management, and now under acute pressure to carry a workforce through AI transformation without losing it.

We’re not creating a new budget; we’re a sharper instrument for one that already exists — and one regulators and works councils increasingly require to be privacy-first.

Land

Start with one team that opts in — a fast, low-friction pilot, not a company-wide rollout.

Expand

Team wins become org rollout; the Respect Index becomes a tracked people-analytics KPI for the transformation.

Per-seat SaaS — and every employee is a seat.

A mirror for *everyone*, not a dashboard for a few managers — so it's whole-company adoption, priced per seat. And the cost to serve stays tiny because it scales with **message volume, not headcount**.

Recurring

Per-active-participant monthly subscription; annual contracts at the org tier.

Every seat, margin-accretive

Universal adoption, not power-users; each new seat adds far more revenue than cost.

Defensible margin

Cost scales with scored volume; the taxonomy and trust posture are the durable moat.

≈ \$0.30

per opted-in employee / month to serve on Sonnet (~\$0.10 on Haiku).

~90%+

modeled gross margin at an illustrative \$4 / seat / month.

Volume-based

cost tracks messages, not seats — so it holds at 50 or 50,000 people.

Modeled from LLM token costs at ~75% opt-in (250-person example ≈ \$35–70/mo to serve). Message volume is the main driver; \$4/seat is illustrative — replace with your numbers before presenting.

Not a slideware idea — a working prototype.

The full loop runs today, end-to-end and offline-validated:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ● Live Slack connector — OAuth token, real channel ingestion. | ● Personal mirror — the private, name-attached view. |
| ● Consent gate + Sign-in-with-Slack SSO — opt-in enforced, tamper-proof. | ● Org & team dashboards — Respect Index, trends, k-anonymized. |
| ● Scoring engine — evidence + coaching rewrite per moment. | ● Data layer — identity-keyed, penalty-free purge on opt-out. |

Next: design partners for a live pilot, and calibration of the Index against real retention / engagement outcomes.

The pain is real — and people told us so.

In discovery conversations with leaders and individual contributors alike, two themes surfaced again and again: **people don't feel heard**, and they've **never had a structured way to reflect on their own behavior**. The published research says the same thing at scale.

74%

are **more effective** at their job when they feel heard.

UKG Workforce Institute

10–15%

of people are truly **self-aware** — though 95% think they are.

T. Eurich, Harvard Business Review

4.6×

more likely to do their **best work** when they feel their voice is heard.

Salesforce Research

The market feels unheard and can't see itself. SugApp is built for exactly that gap — and our own conversations confirm the demand.

Built from twenty years inside the problem.

Suguna Mannepalli — 20+ years leading teams in corporate IT, and an accredited leadership coach (Association for Coaching). SugApp comes from both chairs: the operator who watched culture break, and the coach who helps people change.

What I kept seeing

The loudest voice gets mistaken for the most knowledgeable. Hierarchy quietly overrides better judgment. People in power rarely get to see their own behavior — while the teams beneath them are scrutinized for echoing it.

What actually changes people

Told to change, people get defensive. **Heard**, and given room to reflect, they improve on their own — and outperform. The lost skill of our moment isn't communication — it's **listening**.

SugApp productizes that coaching truth: a private mirror for self-reflection, never a manager's verdict.

What we want from Launch Chapel Hill.

Design partners

Warm intros to 3-5 teams (10-40 people) going through change and willing to run a consented 6-week pilot and co-develop the Index.

Pre-seed & mentorship

Runway to calibrate the model and land the first paying pilots, plus go-to-market and enterprise-privacy guidance.

Every company is asking their people to change faster than ever. **Respect is the leading indicator of whether they can** — and no one else is measuring it.